

Tatiana Samarakovskaya

Creative Director / Head of Creative

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Moscow · open to business travel · work format: office, hybrid, remote

About

Creative director with 10+ years of experience in advertising campaigns, brand communications, special projects and complex multimedia projects.

For the past 5 years I have led the creative function on the client side. I specialize in developing and launching complex creative projects and new products from scratch. I define the creative strategy, big idea and positioning, shape the user experience and visual direction, and own the art direction and development of the concept from the first decision through production and launch.

I present and defend concepts to leadership and am accountable for budgets, timelines, quality and the integrity of the result. I run several projects and creative streams at once and have worked on projects with budgets of up to RUB 150 million.

I work where creative, brand, marketing, content and technology meet. My portfolio includes 360° campaigns, OOH / DOOH, CGI, digital, special projects, partner integrations, offline projects and multimedia exhibitions.

I lead cross-functional teams of 5–30+ people and organize the work of in-house specialists, freelancers, agencies and production companies. I am responsible for the quality of the creative product, key decisions, budgets, timelines and delivery. I present and defend concepts to shareholders, top management, partners and clients.

AI tools are built into my pipeline to optimize production resources, time and budget.

I connect a strong creative idea with the realities of production: I can not only come up with a campaign or a new product, but also see it through to a high-quality, working result.

I love doing what no one has done before.

Work experience

November 2021 — present

Vozrozhdenie VVTs

Moscow

Creative Director, Moskvarium

Moskvarium is one of the largest aquariums in Europe.

– Leading the company’s creative function: advertising campaigns, brand communications, special projects, multimedia and interactive projects, new creative products and brand activations.

– Leading cross-functional project teams of 5–30+ people: art directors, designers, CG/3D and motion specialists, scriptwriters, copywriters, architects, illustrators, developers. Managing several projects and streams at once.

– End-to-end development and launch of new creative products and online and offline projects: creative strategy, big idea, positioning, storytelling, user experience design, production, launch and further development.

– Creative leadership of integrated 360° campaigns: developing and evolving the creative idea for OOH/DOOH, CGI, digital, AR, special projects and partner integrations.

– Creative direction and art direction: building a unified visual and narrative language across projects, including key visuals, mascots, UI, CG/3D, motion, content and brand communications. Overseeing the integrity and quality of execution at every stage.

– Presenting and defending creative strategies, concepts and decisions to stakeholders, the commercial team and partners; making the case for the value of each solution for the audience, the brand and the business.

– Managing production and budgets: building the production model, briefing, selecting contractors, running tenders, controlling timelines, quality, estimates and risks.

– Introducing AI into creative and production processes, developing hybrid production pipelines, optimizing processes and budgets.

Key projects

– CapybaraBooom: developing and launching from scratch a multimedia phygital exhibition as a standalone ticketed product for Moskvarium. An original character universe and more than 60 pieces of content. Attendance of up to 10,000 visitors a month, rated 4.9 on Yandex Maps. Brought cost and delivery time to less than half of the market estimate through hybrid production.

– Moskvarium's 10th anniversary 360° campaign: big idea, 6 key visuals, a 30-meter art object, a CGI film, AR special projects, an OOH/DOOH campaign in Moscow and a collaboration with the Moscow Department of Transport that released a themed Troika transit card.

– Way of Water: developing and launching a 500 m^2 family edutainment product with 19 interactive installations, an RFID quest and panoramic projections. Responsible for the concept, narrative system, visitor journey, art direction, production and budgets.

– Clean Ocean, an environmental WebAR special project created with the creative agency BBDO: more than 80 outdoor advertising placements across Moscow (OTS 133 million), media coverage (OTS 959K) and Telegram (audience of 1.2 million).

March 2018 — October 2021

Phygitech / Hello.IO

Lead Creative

– Developing creative concepts for client briefs: brand activations, interactive installations, educational projects, multimedia exhibitions and parks, city festivals, cultural and entertainment projects.

– Full cycle of creative development: analyzing the client's brief, the competitive landscape and existing solutions on the market; shaping the idea, project structure, scenario logic and interaction mechanics, and presenting the concept.

– Pitching and defending solutions to clients: preparing presentations, concept documents and project proposals; making the case for the idea, project structure, user experience, visual direction, key mechanics and the value of the solution for the brand or venue.

– Shaping the visual direction of projects: briefing and overseeing the creative team of creatives, copywriters, scriptwriters, concept artists, illustrators, designers and 3D visualizers.

– Developing and refining concepts after project approval to reflect client comments, technical constraints and changing inputs; keeping the creative idea intact during execution.

– Designing user logic and interaction scenarios: game mechanics, quest elements, physical outcomes of interaction, re-engagement mechanics and scenarios for different age groups.

– Working in a cross-functional team with the senior creative director, art directors, designers, scriptwriters, developers, technical specialists, producers and managers.

– Adapting concepts to technical, budget and venue constraints without breaking the central idea.

Key projects

Soyuzmultpark Kazan, Soyuzmultpark Moscow, Jurassic Ocean Moscow, the Brighter Together festival at VDNKh, city festivals, interactive installations and multimedia solutions for cultural, educational and entertainment projects.

June 2015 — August 2018

Project work

Multimedia Designer

Freelance and project work for various clients

– Creating video content, motion graphics and branded projection materials for theater productions, shows, festivals, Expo and brand events.

– Contributing to concepts for multimedia events: visual idea, structure of the video sequence, references, the logic of how content appears, and how the video serves the director's, musical or event goals.

– Working on theater and stage projects: adapting video to the director's concept, set design, lighting, musical structure and the performers' movement.

– Creating video content for festival and architectural projection formats, including projects for the Circle of Light festival and other multimedia shows.

– Working with tools for video editing, motion graphics, compositing and image processing; preparing files for stage, festival and projection display.

Projects and collaborations

– Praktika Theatre: video content and multimedia support for theater productions.

– Mariinsky Theatre Lab, Saint Petersburg: video projections, light and graphic effects, working with live video and graphics in an experimental stage format.

– Iyul Ensemble: visuals for a music project, including the video sequence, motion graphics and stage atmosphere.

– Circle of Light festival: contributing to video content for architectural projection and the festival's multimedia format.

July 2014 — April 2016

ADV

Moscow

Creative Designer

– Developing creative solutions for advertising campaigns, digital special projects and non-standard ad formats: from analyzing the client brief and finding the idea to visual direction, project structure and launch.

– Concepts for digital special projects: participation mechanics, user journey, interactive logic, visual presentation and the project's value for the brand.

– Key visuals and campaign visual systems: promo graphics, banner sets, graphics for social media, presentations and landing pages; adaptations for digital and offline media, including posters and print materials.

– Web design for advertising projects: promo sites, landing pages, interactive pages, interface scenarios, screen structure and preparing layouts for development.

– Scripts for commercials, promo videos and digital content: idea, structure, key scenes, visual devices, presentation of the product or brand.

– Preparing and supporting shoots: storyboards, references, production materials, client approvals; on set, making sure the shoot matches the idea, script and style of the campaign.

July 2009 — July 2014

Actis Wunderman

Moscow

Creative Designer

– Grew from technical designer to creative designer: from preparing and adapting advertising materials to contributing to creative concepts, digital special projects and web products.

– Contributing to concepts for advertising campaigns, digital special projects, promo sites, mobile and iPad apps, branded online mechanics and materials for integrated communications.

– Web design for advertising and branded projects: promo pages, landing pages, interface solutions, visual page structure, banner formats, preparing materials for development.

– Graphics for digital campaigns: banner sets, visuals for special projects, materials for social media, email newsletters and presentations.

– Working with the brand books and guidelines of international and Russian clients: adapting visual solutions to brand requirements, placement format, communication channel and technical constraints.

– Print, POS materials and packaging: design, adapting campaigns to print formats and physical media, layout and prepress.

– Projects for major international and Russian brands: BMW, Audi, Microsoft, Ford, L'Oréal, Colgate, Canon, Jaguar, Unilever, Adidas, Mastercard, Coca-Cola, Michelin, Citibank and others.

Education

2017

British Higher School of Art and Design (BHSAD)
Design for Interactive Environments

2009

Ogarev Mordovia State University
Faculty of Geography, Geoecologist

Languages and skills

Languages

Russian — native
English — B2, upper-intermediate

Skills

Team management · Design · Exhibition development · Brand development · Creativity · Creating ad creatives · Concept development · Product concept development · Adobe Photoshop · English · Advertising · Scriptwriting · Exhibition organization · Event organization · Brand promotion · Branding · AI visualization · AI · AI production · Advertising campaigns · Special projects · Offline events · Content production · Copywriting · Art direction · Budget management · Producing